

KRIS LAI

Senior AI Engineer

 laikris

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 kriskirla

EXPERIENCE

Senior AI Engineer | SleekFlow Technologies Limited Aug 2025 – Present

- Led the end-to-end R&D and production deployment of LLM-driven CRM automation, dynamically updating customer lead stages across millions of daily messages in multiple regions and scaling prototypes into core product offerings.
- Architected a highly configurable agent engine allowing non-technical users to deploy custom, rule-bound response agents. Designed a multi-stage Plan-Draft-Self-Review pipeline that dynamically translates arbitrary user prompts into structured constraints to drastically minimize hallucinations while optimizing the latency profile.
- Engineered internal AI-augmented development workflows utilizing advanced context window optimization, custom RAG pipelines, and sub-agent orchestration, accelerating engineering velocity by more than 150% across the team's development ecosystems.

Senior Software Engineer | Morningstar, Inc Jan 2022 – July 2025

- Architected and led the migration of a core portfolio analytics engine to a high-scale, cross-region AWS serverless architecture (ECS, Fargate, Lambda), enabling seamless support for large-scale portfolio analysis on the Morningstar Workstation Platform.
- Designed high-performance .NET analytics services that utilize DynamoDB and event-driven patterns, drastically improving the performance of complex portfolio risk scoring while maintaining cost efficiency.
- Established operational excellence by implementing enterprise-grade disaster recovery (Route 53, Global DynamoDB), IaC via Terraform, and automated security/compliance gates (SOC 2, SonarQube, Checkmarx) to ensure system reliability and code quality.

Full Stack Software Engineer | Peak Power Inc Jul 2020 – Jan 2022

- Engineered a scalable full-stack analytics platform (Angular, Spring Boot, Java) enabling customers to derive actionable insights from real-time energy, occupancy, and climate telemetry across enterprise building portfolios.
- Architected a high-throughput, multi-threaded Java driver for global IoT device connectivity, improving system latency by 5x and significantly reducing maintenance overhead compared to legacy communication protocols.
- Built robust data infrastructure and observability by implementing real-time stream processing with Kafka and Python, ensuring high data integrity for automated alerting and maintaining system reliability through containerization (Docker) and comprehensive monitoring (Datadog, Sentry).

Software Development Team Lead | IBM Feb 2019 – Jul 2020

- Pioneered "Project ARBIT," architecting a standalone Python/Go RESTful microservice containerized with Docker to automate Db2 failure investigations, reducing annual operational overhead by approximately \$1M.
- Led a cross-functional functional verification team of 11 developers and QA engineers, streamlining release pipelines to transition core Db2 components from development to production with minimal error rates.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate | AWS  Nov 2022 – Nov 2025
- Enterprise Design Thinking - Team Essentials for AI | IBM  Jun 2019
- Enterprise Design Thinking Co-Creator | IBM  Jun 2019

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) | University of Toronto 2013 – 2018

- Computer Science - Specialist in Software Engineering

LANGUAGES

English (Native), Cantonese (Native),
Mandarin (Fluent)